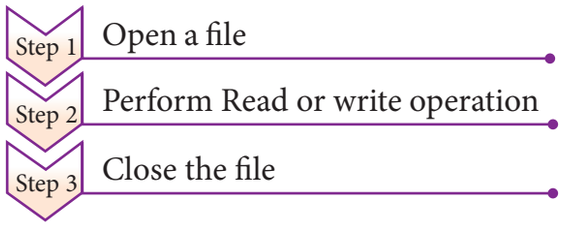
When you want to read from or write to a file ,you need to open it. Once the reading is over it needs to be closed. So that, resources that are tied with the file are freed. Hence, in Python, a file operation takes place in the following order



Note

File name or the complete path name can be represented either with in " " or in ' ' in the open command.

Python has a built-in function open() to open a file. This function returns a **file object,** also called a **handle,** as it is used to read or modify the file accordingly.

For Example

```
>>> f = open("sample.txt")  # open file in current directory and f is file object
>>> f = open('c:\pyprg\ch13sample5.csv')# specifying full path
```

You can specify the mode while opening a file. In mode, you can specify whether you want to read **'r',** write **'w'** or append **'a'** to the file. you can also specify "text or binary" in which the file is to be opened.

The default is reading in text mode. In this mode, while reading from the file the data would be in the format of **strings.**

On the other hand, **binary mode returns bytes and this is the mode to be used when dealing with non-text files like image or exe files.**

Python File Modes

Mode	Description
'r'	Open a file for reading. (default)
'w'	Open a file for writing. Creates a new file if it does not exist or truncates the file if it exists.
'x'	Open a file for exclusive creation. If the file already exists, the operation fails.

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